SURVIVAL-TIPS

Infrastructure & Civilization

Community systems, communications, public health, transport, governance, and resilient infrastructure.

Stage 08 • Generated 2026-10-30 • 7 knowledge entries

How to use this handbook

Use this guide as a learning aid, not as a substitute for official emergency instructions or expert assessment. Every AI-extracted tip must be reviewed before it is treated as verified guidance. Never infer that a wild plant, mushroom, water source, or improvised material is safe based on appearance alone.

1. Include All 10 Required Elements in a Public Notice

Prepare drinking-water public notices that clearly explain the violation and include all 10 elements identified in the EPA Public Notification Rule reference.

Action type: communication_guidance

Steps

1. Explain the violation clearly and in plain language.

2. Include the 10 elements: violation, contaminant, timing, health effects, vulnerable populations, alternate water use, consumer actions, system response, compliance timeline, and contact information.

3. Check the notice against the EPA Public Notification Rule reference before distribution.

Warnings

• This tip summarizes notice content; it is not a substitute for checking the current rule and jurisdiction-specific requirements.

Review status: needs_review • Category: water

Source: Preparing an Advisory Drinking Water Advisory Communications Toolbox | Water, Sanitation, & Hygiene-related Emergencies & and Outbreaks | Healthy Water | CDC — https://archive.cdc.gov/www_cdc_gov/healthywater/emergency/dwa-comm-toolbox/during/preparing.html

2. Translate Messages Through Community Partners

Use trusted community partners or professional translators to produce accessible versions of advisories, avoiding automated translation tools.

Action type: communication_guidance

Steps

1. Use community partners or professional translation services to translate the message.

2. Avoid relying on online dictionaries or generic computer translation software for the advisory.

Warnings

• Have translations checked by people who understand the language and context before public release.

Review status: needs_review • Category: water

Source: Preparing an Advisory Drinking Water Advisory Communications Toolbox | Water, Sanitation, & Hygiene-related Emergencies & and Outbreaks | Healthy Water | CDC — https://archive.cdc.gov/www_cdc_gov/healthywater/emergency/dwa-comm-toolbox/during/preparing.html

3. Employ Multiple Communication Channels

Disseminate advisories through a mix of traditional media, SMS, social media, and variable message signs to reach diverse audiences.

Action type: communication_guidance

Steps

1. Consider multiple communication channels in addition to traditional media.

2. Choose channels appropriate to the audience and the advisory context.

Warnings

• A single channel may not reach everyone; the source excerpt does not prescribe a universal channel mix.

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Source: Preparing an Advisory Drinking Water Advisory Communications Toolbox | Water, Sanitation, & Hygiene-related Emergencies & and Outbreaks | Healthy Water | CDC — https://archive.cdc.gov/www_cdc_gov/healthywater/emergency/dwa-comm-toolbox/during/preparing.html

4. Designate and Rehearse a Credible Spokesperson

Choose an authoritative spokesperson and rehearse key messages to ensure consistent, trustworthy communication during an advisory.

Action type: communication_guidance

Steps

1. Designate a spokesperson who has authority and is honest, credible, competent, accessible, and sensitive to public concerns.

Warnings

• The source excerpt describes spokesperson qualities; it does not establish a specific rehearsal protocol.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Preparing an Advisory Drinking Water Advisory Communications Toolbox | Water, Sanitation, & Hygiene-related Emergencies & and Outbreaks | Healthy Water | CDC — https://archive.cdc.gov/www_cdc_gov/healthywater/emergency/dwa-comm-toolbox/during/preparing.html

5. Encourage Notice Sharing

Include a statement urging recipients to forward the advisory to others, amplifying reach and community awareness.

Action type: communication_guidance

Steps

1. Where applicable, include a statement encouraging recipients to share the notice with other people.

Review status: needs_review • Category: water

Source: Preparing an Advisory Drinking Water Advisory Communications Toolbox | Water, Sanitation, & Hygiene-related Emergencies & and Outbreaks | Healthy Water | CDC — https://archive.cdc.gov/www_cdc_gov/healthywater/emergency/dwa-comm-toolbox/during/preparing.html

6. Use Abbreviated Messages for Space■Limited Channels

Craft concise messages that convey essential actions for channels like SMS, social media, and broadcast alerts.

Action type: communication_guidance

Steps

1. Use brief messages for space-limited channels such as on-screen scrolling messages, text-message systems, and social media.

2. Keep essential safety information available through a fuller notice or linked channel.

Warnings

• Do not shorten a message in a way that removes essential protective instructions.

Review status: needs_review • Category: water

Source: Preparing an Advisory Drinking Water Advisory Communications Toolbox | Water, Sanitation, & Hygiene-related Emergencies & and Outbreaks | Healthy Water | CDC — https://archive.cdc.gov/www_cdc_gov/healthywater/emergency/dwa-comm-toolbox/during/preparing.html

7. Customize Chemical Contaminant Advisories with Expert Input

When chemical contaminants are involved, consult experts and tailor messages to specific health impacts and exposure routes.

Action type: communication_guidance

Steps

1. For advisories involving chemical contaminants, consult relevant experts about potential health impacts and exposure routes.

2. Customize the message to the specific contaminant.

Warnings

• Do not reuse a generic microbial-contamination message for a chemical contaminant without expert review.

Review status: needs_review • Category: water

Source: Preparing an Advisory Drinking Water Advisory Communications Toolbox | Water, Sanitation, & Hygiene-related Emergencies & and Outbreaks | Healthy Water | CDC — https://archive.cdc.gov/www_cdc_gov/healthywater/emergency/dwa-comm-toolbox/during/preparing.html